

# Peng Liu, Ph.D.

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## Research Interests

Automated proofreading and error correction in connectomics (ML approaches for error detection and human-in-the-loop proofreading)

Label-efficient biomedical image segmentation (semi-supervised and weakly-supervised learning)

Foundation models and benchmarks for scalable multi-organelle EM segmentation

## Academic Appointments and Professional Experience

### Academic Appointments

Aug 2024 – Present      **Boston College, Department of Computer Science**      **Boston, MA, USA**  
Postdoctoral Researcher (Advisor: Prof. Donglai Wei)

- Research focus: 3D volume EM segmentation for mitochondria, nuclei, and pan-organelle analysis.
- Led benchmark-centered research including MitoEM 2.0 (*Scientific Data*, under review).
- **1<sup>st</sup> Place**, CellMap Segmentation Challenge (2026; eFIB-SEM, 40+ classes).
- Ongoing work on skeleton-guided learning and multi-resolution mixture-of-experts models for instance segmentation.

### Industry Experience

Jul 2017 – Jul 2019      **Meituan**      **Beijing, China**  
Search and Recommendation Algorithm Engineer

- Built ranking and recommendation models for travel products to improve CTR and CVR.
- Core methods: Graph Embedding, DNN, and Wide&Deep.

## Education

2019 – 2024      **Shanghai Jiao Tong University**      **Shanghai, China**  
Ph.D. in Biomedical Engineering

- **Advisor:** Guoyan Zheng
- **Dissertation:** Semi-Supervised Medical Image Analysis Based on Consistency Regularization

2015 – 2018      **University of Chinese Academy of Sciences (Aerospace Information Research Institute)**      **Beijing, China**  
M.Sc. in Signal and Information Processing

- **Thesis:** Object Detection in High-Resolution Remote Sensing Images Based on Deep Learning

2011 – 2015      **China University of Geosciences**      **Beijing, China**  
B.Sc. in Geographic Information System

## Publications (\* indicates equal contribution)

### Journal Articles

- 1 **P. Liu** and G. Zheng, "Handling imbalanced data: Uncertainty-guided virtual adversarial training with batch nuclear-norm optimization for semi-supervised medical image classification," *IEEE Journal of Biomedical and Health Informatics*, vol. 26, no. 7, pp. 2983–2994, 2022, (JCR Q1, □□□□□, IF=6.8).
- 2 **P. Liu** and G. Zheng, "Cvcl: Context-aware voxel-wise contrastive learning for label-efficient multi-organ segmentation," *Computers in Biology and Medicine*, vol. 160, p. 106995, 2023, (JCR Q1, IF=6.3).
- 3 C. Chen\*, **P. Liu\***, and Y. Song, "Diagnostic performance for severity grading of hip osteoarthritis and osteonecrosis of femoral head on radiographs: Deep learning model vs. board-certified orthopaedic surgeons," *Osteoarthritis Imaging*, vol. 3, no. 2, p. 100092, 2023.
- 4 **P. Liu**, M. Zhang, X. Gao, B. Li, and G. Zheng, "Joint lymphoma lesion segmentation and prognosis prediction from baseline fdg-pet images via multitask convolutional neural networks," *IEEE Access*, vol. 10, pp. 81612–81623, 2022, (JCR Q2, IF=3.6).
- 5 Z. Li, K. Chen, **P. Liu**, X. Chen, and G. Zheng, "Entropy and distance maps-guided segmentation of articular cartilage: Data from the osteoarthritis initiative," *International Journal of Computer Assisted Radiology and Surgery*, pp. 1–8, 2022, (JCR Q2).
- 6 **P. Liu** and G. Zheng, "Cr-gloco: Cross-resolution learning via global-local context consistency for semi-supervised 3d medical segmentation," *Computerized Medical Imaging and Graphics*, 2026, Accepted and available online (in press), (JCR Q1, IF=4.9).

### Preprints

- 1 A. Bhardwaj, C. W. Dell, M. R. Mikolaj, H. Spiers, A. Harned, B. Kuppusamy, **P. Liu**, D. Wei, E. Sterneck, and K. Narayan, "Nucleonet and dropnet: Generalist deep learning models for instance segmentation of nuclei and lipid droplets from electron microscopy images," *bioRxiv*, p. 2026.04.02.713930, 2026.  DOI: 10.64898/2026.04.02.713930.
- 2 M. Wang, **P. Liu**, Y. Zhao, B. Wang, J. Wan, L. Nie, and D. Wei, "Nugraph: Graph-based reasoning over 3d primitives for nucleus segmentation correction," *bioRxiv*, p. 2026.05.16.725603, 2026.  DOI: 10.64898/2026.05.16.725603.

### Conference Proceedings

- 1 **P. Liu** and G. Zheng, "Semi-supervised learning regularized by adversarial perturbation and diversity maximization," in *Machine Learning in Medical Imaging: 12th International Workshop, MLMI 2021, Held in Conjunction with MICCAI 2021*, Springer, 2021, pp. 199–208, (EI).
- 2 **P. Liu** and G. Zheng, "Context-aware voxel-wise contrastive learning for label efficient multi-organ segmentation," in *International Conference on Medical Image Computing and Computer-Assisted Intervention*, Springer, 2022, pp. 653–662, (EI, CCF B).
- 3 Q. Zhou\*, **P. Liu\***, and G. Zheng, "Context-aware cutmix is all you need for universal organ and cancer segmentation," in *Fast, Low-Resource, and Accurate Organ and Pan-Cancer Segmentation in Abdomen CT*, Springer, 2023, (EI).
- 4 Q. Zhou, **P. Liu**, and G. Zheng, "Partially supervised multi-organ segmentation via affinity-aware consistency learning and cross site feature alignment," in *International Conference on Medical Image Computing and Computer-Assisted Intervention*, Springer, 2023, pp. 671–680.

### Under Review

- 1 **P. Liu**, B. Shen, L. Liu, Q. Wang, S. Zhang, A. Bhardwaj, I. Arganda-Carreras, K. Narayan, and D. Wei, "Mitoem 2.0: A benchmark for challenging 3d mitochondria instance segmentation from em images," Minor Revision at Scientific Data, 2025, (JCR Q1, IF=6.9).
- 2 D. Shi, Y. Hou, Y. Yan, T.-h. Zhang, W. C. Joesten, **P. Liu**, Y. Wang, M. Gautam, J. Lim, L. Zheng, J. Gould, B. Ko, X. Niu, M.-C. Cheng, J.-C. Hsieh, F. Levet, D. Cai, A. Draelos, D. J. Cai, D. Wei, and C. Linghu, "Simultaneous brain-wide single-cell recording resolves spatiotemporal memory architecture," Under Review at Nature, 2026. [url: https://doi.org/10.1101/2026.05.21.726120](https://doi.org/10.1101/2026.05.21.726120).

## Manuscripts in Preparation

- 1 **P. Liu** and D. Wei, *Anchorslot: Hybrid target coding for volumetric em organelle segmentation*, To be submitted to IEEE Transactions on Medical Imaging, 2026.
- 2 **P. Liu**, D. Roy, and D. Wei, *Affinity-guided superpoint learning for false-merge correction in 3d em mitochondria segmentation*, To be submitted to IEEE Transactions on Medical Imaging, 2026.

## Open-Source Software

CellAble      [github.com/pliu-ai/cellable](https://github.com/pliu-ai/cellable) Interactive 2D/3D annotation and human-in-the-loop proofreading tool for automated cell reconstructions in electron microscopy. Supports TIFF stack viewing, AI-assisted segmentation, manual mask editing, connected-component analysis, and 3D VTK rendering. Built with Python, PyQt5, and VTK.

## Honors and Awards

### Research Competitions

2026      **1<sup>st</sup> Place**, CellMap Segmentation Challenge (eFIB-SEM multi-organelle segmentation, 40+ classes).

2023      **2<sup>nd</sup> Place**, MICCAI FLARE 2023 Challenge (abdominal organ and pan-tumor segmentation; leveraged label-efficient and semi-supervised learning for automated annotation at scale across 4000+ CT scans).

2018      **Ranking: 20/120**, MDD Cup 2018 of Meituan Group. In Kaggle MDD Cup 2018.

2017      **Ranking: 7/148**, MDD Cup 2017 of Meituan Group. In Kaggle MDD Cup 2017.

### Scholarships

2012      **National Encouragement Scholarship**. Awarded by Ministry of Education of China.

2012, 2013, 2014      **University Scholarships**. Awarded by China University of Geosciences.

## Teaching Experience

### Teaching Assistant

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, CS 2901: Programming Ideas and Methods (C), Fall 2021 and Fall 2022.

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, CS 170: Programming Ideas and Methods (C), Fall 2019 and Fall 2020.

### Courses Prepared to Teach

Programming Fundamentals (C/C++/Python)

Data Structures and Algorithms

Introduction to Artificial Intelligence

Machine Learning and Deep Learning  
Digital Image Processing  
Medical Image Processing and Analysis

## Professional Service

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### Journals

*IEEE Transactions on Medical Imaging*  
*Medical Image Analysis*  
*IEEE Journal of Biomedical and Health Informatics*  
*Neural Networks*  
*Computerized Medical Imaging and Graphics*

### Conferences

MICCAI 2021  
MICCAI 2022

## Patents and Software

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### Patent

Peng Liu; Guoyan Zheng. Multi-organ segmentation method, training method, medium, and electronic device. Chinese invention patent application No. 202211185528.1, filed on September 27, 2022.

### Software Copyright

Jiale Wang; Peng Liu; Guoyan Zheng. Deep-learning-based Spine Localization and Segmentation System (Spine\_loc\_seg) V1.0. Registration No. 2023SR0776267, registered on April 28, 2023.

## Technical Skills

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|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Languages | English (professional proficiency; TOEFL, CET-6), Mandarin Chinese (native). |
| Coding    | Linux (7 years), C++ (10 years), Python (7 years), PyTorch (6 years), Git.   |